

DOT

1. Passage anchor

> “Instead, she would break things down step by step and help us **connect the dots**.”

Passage meaning

connect the dots = understand how separate pieces of information are related and form a larger pattern or explanation

把零散資訊串連起來；看出事情之間的關係；理清脈絡

Here, **dot** is figurative. The students are not literally connecting small marks on paper.

Practice

1. A good teacher helps students **connect the dots** between different ideas.

好老師會幫助學生**把不同概念串連起來**。

2. Once I understood the basic principle, I could finally **connect the dots**.

一旦理解了基本原理，我終於能**看出各項資訊之間的關係**。

Core meanings of DOT

2. dot — small round mark

= a very small round mark or spot

點；小圓點

Examples

1. Put a **dot** next to the correct answer.

在正確答案旁邊畫一個**點**。

2. The page was covered with tiny black **dots**.

頁面上布滿細小的黑色**圓點**。

This is the central concrete meaning.

3. dot on a map

= a small mark representing a place or point

****地圖上的點；位置標記****

Examples

1. The town appears as a small ****dot**** on the map.

那座城鎮在地圖上只顯示成一個小****點****。

2. Each ****dot**** represents one village.

每一個****點****代表一個村莊。

Punctuation / notation

4. dot — full stop / period

= a small point used in writing or notation, especially informally referring to “.”

****句點；點號****

Examples

1. Put a ****dot**** at the end of the sentence.

在句尾加一個****句點****。

2. The abbreviation contains several ****dots****.

這個縮寫中有幾個****點號****。

In formal grammar teaching, ****full stop**** or ****period**** is usually preferred.

5. decimal point / dot

= point separating whole numbers from decimal fractions

****小數點****

Examples

1. Read 3.5 as “three ****point**** five,” not “three dot five.”

3.5 通常讀作 “three point five”，不是 “three dot five”。

2. The ****dot**** marks the decimal position.

這個****點****標示小數位置。

The ordinary term is ****decimal point****, but ****dot**** may be used informally in some contexts.

Internet / email / web addresses

6. dot — spoken “.” in an internet or email address

= the symbol “.” pronounced ****dot****

****點****

Examples

1. The website is example ****dot**** com.

網站地址是 example ****點**** com。

2. My email ends in gmail ****dot**** com.

我的電郵地址結尾是 gmail ****點**** com。

Very common spoken use.

7. dot-com

= relating to internet companies, especially those whose websites use .com

****網路公司的；網際網路企業的****

Examples

1. The company grew rapidly during the ****dot-com**** boom.

那家公司在****網路公司熱潮****期間快速成長。

2. Many ****dot-com companies**** failed in the early 2000s.

很多****網路公司****在二十一世紀初倒閉。

Established compound.

Pattern / decoration

8. dot — small spot in a pattern

= one of many small spots used in a design

****小圓點；斑點****

Examples

1. She wore a dress with white ****dots****.

她穿著一件有白色****圓點****的裙子。

2. The fabric has tiny blue ****dots****.

這塊布料上有細小的藍色****點點****。

9. polka dot

= one of many regularly spaced round spots used as a decorative pattern

****圓點圖案；波卡圓點****

Examples

1. She wore a ****polka-dot dress****.

她穿了一件****圓點洋裝****。

2. The bag has a black-and-white ****polka-dot pattern****.

這個包包有黑白****圓點圖案****。

Small visible object / distant speck

10. dot — tiny object seen from a distance

= something that looks like a very small point because it is far away

****小點；遠處的小斑點****

Examples

1. The boat was just a ****dot**** on the horizon.

那艘船在地平線上只像一個小****點****。

2. From the plane, the cars looked like tiny ****dots****.

從飛機上看，汽車就像一個個小****點****。

Verb: cover with small spots

11. dot something with something

= place many small things at different points across an area

****點綴；散布****

Examples

1. Small villages ****dot the countryside****.

小村莊****散布在鄉間****。

2. Trees ****dotted the landscape****.

樹木****零星分布在景色中****。

This is a major figurative verb use.

12. be dotted with

= have many small things scattered across an area

****點綴著；散布著****

Examples

1. The hillside was ****dotted with houses****.

山坡上****零星分布著房屋****。

2. The sky was ****dotted with stars****.

天空****點綴著星星****。

Very common descriptive pattern.

Idiom: connect the dots

13. connect the dots

= understand how separate facts, clues, or events relate to one another

****把線索串連起來；看出關聯；理清脈絡****

This is the exact passage expression.

Examples

1. The evidence only makes sense when you ****connect the dots****.

只有當你****把線索串連起來****，證據才說得通。

2. She helped us ****connect the dots**** between theory and real-life examples.

她幫助我們**把理論和實際例子連結起來**。

14. join the dots

British English often uses **join the dots** for the literal puzzle activity and sometimes figuratively.

= connect separate clues or pieces of information

把點連起來；串連資訊

Examples

1. Children **join the dots** to complete the picture.

孩子們把**點連起來**完成圖畫。

2. Once you **join the dots**, the pattern becomes obvious.

一旦你**把線索串起來**，整個模式就很明顯。

Dot as a precise point in time

15. on the dot

= exactly at the stated time

準時；正好在某個時間

Examples

1. The meeting starts at nine **on the dot**.

會議九點**整準時**開始。

2. She arrived at six **on the dot**.

她六點**整準時**到達。

Very common idiom.

Dot as tiny amount / point

16. a dot of something

= a very small amount of something

一小點；一丁點

Examples

1. Add a **dot of glue** to the corner.
在角落加**一點膠水**。
2. There was a **dot of paint** on his sleeve.
他袖子上有**一點油漆**。

Technical / mathematical uses

17. dot product

= mathematical operation combining two vectors to produce a scalar
點積；**內積**

Examples

1. Students learned how to calculate the **dot product** of two vectors.
學生學習如何計算兩個向量的**點積**。
2. The **dot product** is widely used in physics and mathematics.
點積在物理和數學中廣泛使用。

Established technical term.

18. dot notation

= notation using dots to represent derivatives, multiplication, access, or other functions depending on the field
點記法

Examples

1. Newton used **dot notation** for time derivatives.
牛頓使用**點記法**表示時間導數。
2. Some programming languages use **dot notation** to access properties.
有些程式語言使用**點記法**存取屬性。

Computing

19. dot file

= file whose name begins with a dot, often hidden on Unix-like systems

****點檔案；隱藏檔案****

Examples

1. The configuration is stored in a ****dot file****.

設定儲存在一個****點檔案****中。

2. Some ****dot files**** are hidden by default.

有些****點檔案****預設會被隱藏。

Specialist computing sense.

Medical / visual spots

20. dot — tiny visible spot or mark

= a small spot appearing on a surface, image, skin, etc.

****小點；斑點****

Examples

1. There was a red ****dot**** on the screen.

螢幕上有一個紅色****小點****。

2. She noticed a tiny ****dot**** on the page.

她注意到頁面上有一個小****點****。

This usually remains within the central concrete meaning rather than forming a separate sense.

Related forms

21. dotted

= marked or covered with small dots, or scattered across an area

****有圓點的；點綴著的；散布的****

Examples

1. She wore a ****dotted shirt****.

她穿了一件****圓點襯衫****。

2. The coast is ****dotted with small villages****.

海岸沿線****散布著小村莊****。

22. dotty

Possible meanings include:

A. covered with dots

****有圓點的****

B. informal, especially BrE: slightly silly or eccentric

****有點古怪的；糊塗的****

This is more peripheral and lower priority.

Key contrasts

23. dot vs point

****dot****

= small visible round mark

****點；圓點****

****point****

= exact location, position, or abstract point; can also be a small mark

****點；位置；要點****

Compare:

> Put a ****dot**** on the page.

> 在紙上畫一個小圓點。

> Mark the exact ****point**** where the lines meet.

> 標出兩條線相交的確切位置。

They overlap, but ****dot**** is more strongly visual.

24. dot vs spot

****spot****

= small mark, patch, or place

****斑點；小塊；地點****

****dot****

= usually a smaller, rounder point-like mark

Compare:

> a red ****dot****

> 一個紅色小點

> a dark ****spot****

> 一塊深色斑點

25. dot vs mark

****mark****

= any visible sign, line, stain, symbol, etc.

****記號；痕跡****

****dot****

= specific small round mark

So every dot is a kind of mark, but not every mark is a dot.

26. connect the dots vs understand

****understand****

= broad general comprehension

****connect the dots****

= specifically see the relationship among separate pieces of information

Compare:

> I understand the formula.

> 我理解這條公式。

> I finally **connected the dots** between the formula and the experiment.

> 我終於**看出公式和實驗之間的關係**。

This distinction is central to the passage.

Meaning map

The central concrete meaning of **dot** is:

a very small round point or mark

From this develop:

Writing

dot / full stop

→ **點號 / 句點**

Addresses

dot com

→ **點**

Pattern

polka dot

→ **圓點圖案**

Distance

a dot on the horizon

→ **遠處的小點**

Scattered objects

villages dot the landscape

→ **零星散布**

Figurative reasoning

connect the dots

→ **把零散資訊串連起來**

Time

on the dot

→ **正好 / 準時**

Mathematics

dot product

→ **點積**

The passage uses the figurative reasoning branch:

individual dots

→ **separate pieces of information**

connecting the dots

→ **seeing how those pieces fit together**

MCQ-ready master list

Form / sense	MCQ-ready Traditional Chinese meaning
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dot — small round mark	非常小的圓形記號；點 / 小圓點
dot on a map	用來表示位置、城鎮等的地圖小點
dot — punctuation	書寫或符號系統中的小點；非正式可指句點 / 點號
dot in web/email address	網址或電郵地址中的「.」；口語讀作 dot
dot-com	與 .com 網路公司或網路產業有關的
dot — decorative spot	圖案上的小圓點 / 斑點
polka dot	規則排列的圓點圖案
dot — distant object	因距離太遠而看起來像小點的物體
dot something / be dotted with	小型事物零星分布在某地；點綴 / 散布
connect the dots	把分散的事實、線索或概念串連起來，理解彼此關係
join the dots	把點連接起來；也可比喻串連線索
on the dot	正好在指定時間；準時
a dot of something	非常少量的一點某物
dot product	數學中兩個向量運算所得的點積 / 內積
dot notation	使用點符號表示特定數學、物理或程式操作的點記法
dot file	檔名以點開頭的檔案，常作隱藏 / 設定檔用途
dotted	帶有圓點的；或零星散布著某物的

Passage recap

> “...she would break things down step by step and help us **connect the dots**.”

Here:

connect the dots = **understand how separate facts or ideas relate to each other**

Best Traditional Chinese:

* **把零散資訊串連起來**

* **看出不同概念之間的關係**

* **理清脈絡**

* **把各個線索連起來**

Natural contextual translation:

她會一步一步拆解概念，幫助我們把零散的資訊串連起來。

Passage MCQ-ready meaning

connect the dots

= **see the relationships among separate pieces of information and understand the larger pattern**

把資訊串連起來；看出關聯；理清整體脈絡

The metaphor is:

separate dots on a page

→ **separate facts or ideas**

then:

connect the dots

→ **see how all the information fits together**.